



INDUSTRY NEWS

INDUSTRY UPDATES

Mobile component manufacturing value to cross ₹ 700 billion by March: ICEA

India's mobile handset component manufacturing will cross ₹ 700 billion in terms of value by the end of the current fiscal, as against ₹ 500 billion target set under the phased manufacturing programme for the fiscal year 2019-2020, India Cellular and Electronics Association (ICEA) said in a statement.

Pankaj Mohindroo, chairman of

ICEA, informed *Economic Times* that it is a matter of great satisfaction that the vertical of PCBA itself will see manufacturing value of over ₹ 500 billion. He was optimistic by seeing the progress of charger manufacturing where India has also started exporting. Mohindroo believes that these achievements will ensure India's viability to build a robust electronics manufacturing hub.

35 capital goods exempted from basic customs duty

In a notification dated September 28, the finance ministry exempted items such as PCB, coating machine, PCB assembly loader and unloader from the basic customs duty. Thirty five capital goods (mentioned in the circular vide notification no. 71/2018) are used for manufacturing components such as lithium-ion batteries, speakers and receivers of cellphones, data cables, optical-fibres and so on.

Industry body ELCINA, while appreciating the notification, said that all goods in the new list have HS Codes (codes required for imports)

at eight-digit tariff level, which will aid fast customs clearance.

Recently, various electronics associations had raised the concern that a lot of new capital goods were not covered under the original custom notification (no. 25/2002). According to them, these needed to be exempted from the basic customs duty to further aid the growing manufacturing landscape of the country. With regards to this concern, associations and industry bodies proposed a total of 200 such capital goods, out of which around 35 items were accepted for the exemption with effect from September 2018.

Remembering Om Wadhwa

The year 2018 ended on a sad note for the Indian electronics industry, as the news spread about the passing of Om Wadhwa, chairman and managing director, JV Electronics, and a highly revered veteran of the industry. He passed away peacefully on the morning of December 29, 2018 at 7am at his residence in New Delhi. The late Om Wadhwa (1938-2018) was a visionary and a trailblazer in the field of India's electronic components exports—and this was at a time when the nation's electronics industry had just begun to take shape. His leadership and efforts made JV Electronics one of the top exporters of electronic components to the US and Europe.

On The Move

Shilpa Dureja Puri appointed general manager - digital at Samsung Electronics

Shilpa Dureja Puri has been appointed as general manager - digital at Samsung India. Prior to this, she was working with Microsoft as director marketing - digital and experiential. Puri has around 19 years of experience in digital marketing and strategy, spanning multiple industries.

Siddharth Banerjee joins Facebook India as director - global sales organisation

Siddharth Banerjee, who was executive vice president - marketing at Vodafone, has joined Facebook's India operations as director- global sales organisation (GSO). In this new role, Banerjee will be responsible for partnering businesses for Facebook India, and will lead agency relationships and verticals in his field.

Appointments at EESL

Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL) has appointed Venkatesh Dwivedi as director (projects) and S. Gopal as director (commercial). Prior to this appointment, Dwivedi was working as EESL's chief operating officer. He was also national programme manager for Street Light National Programme (SLNP) and the first project manager of EESL's flagship scheme Unnat Jyoti by Affordable LEDs for All (UJALA).

Gopal was earlier EESL's chief general manager (finance), and was managing the financial and commercial activities of EESL, including financial planning, resource mobilisation and treasury management.

iRAM Technologies appoints Sameer Koul to fuel expansion in West India

iRAM Technologies has announced the appointment of Sameer Koul as regional director - sales and alliances, western region, India. In his role, Koul will strategise growth and expansion of iRAM Technologies across western and central India. He will be responsible for developing relationship with municipal corporation and state government and with onboarding partners/ dealers.